

Fix the portfolio's efficiency. Use the festival as the engine.

My first month as Music Creator Manager · Belle He · August 2026

1 · COACH BY ARCHETYPE

The portfolio's problem is **efficiency**, **not effort**: the most active creators are declining. Two failure patterns, two coaching plans.

2 · FESTIVAL AS ENGINE, NOT EVENT

A "Road to Pulse" **competition** recruits new music creators and gives existing ones the discovery they are starved of; one mechanic, two funnels.

3 · SUPPLY-FIRST METRICS

Revenue follows retention and discovery. **Leading indicators gate every dollar** of the \$80K budget, with a go/no-go checkpoint at week 4.

PORTFOLIO DIAGNOSIS

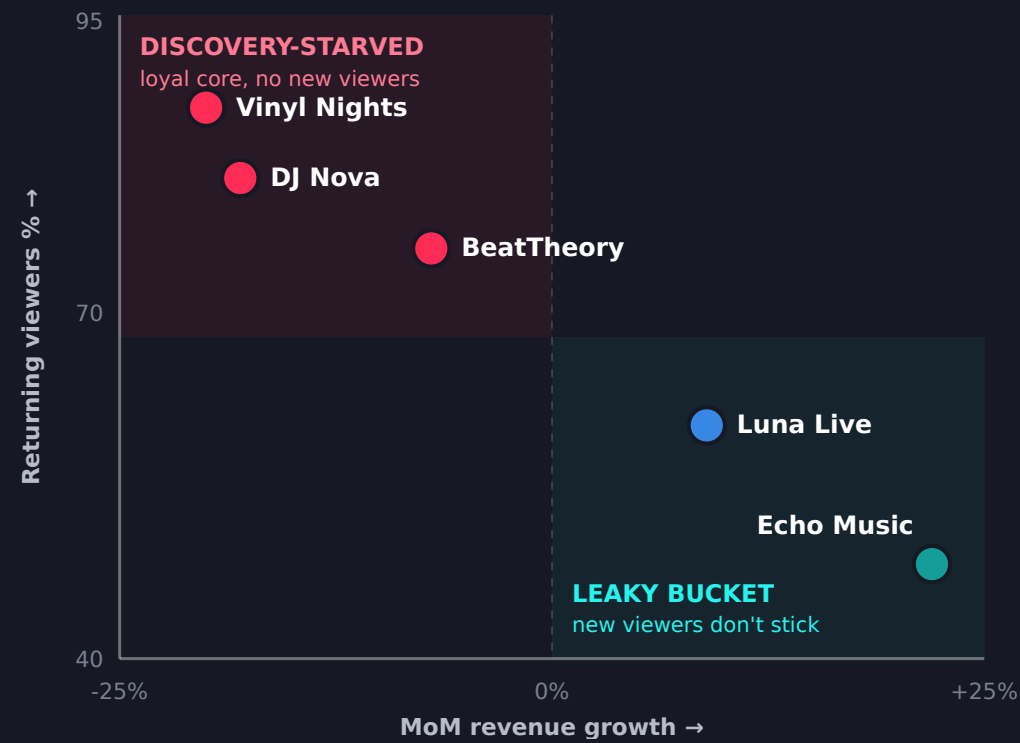
The most active creators are declining: an efficiency problem, not an effort problem

Last 30 days. Revenue per LIVE hour spans 5× across the portfolio.

CREATOR	LIVE HRS	AVG CCV	REVENUE	REV / HR	MOM	RETURNING
Echo Music	38	1,250	\$12,100	\$318	+22%	48%
Luna Live	58	910	\$17,600	\$303	+9%	60%
DJ Nova	115	430	\$14,200	\$123	-18%	81%
BeatTheory	90	310	\$10,400	\$116	-7%	75%
Vinyl Nights	126	185	\$7,800	\$62	-20%	87%

Hours and growth are **inversely related**: the two creators streaming the most (126h, 115h) are declining fastest. The portfolio needs **better hours, not more hours**.

RETURNING VIEWERS VS. REVENUE GROWTH (MOM)



87% returning viewers with -20% revenue isn't loyalty. **It's a ceiling.**

CREATOR STRATEGY

Grow two, fix two, sustain one: prioritized by where coaching changes the trajectory

Each archetype gets a different playbook. Coaching effort is a scarce resource; it goes where it bends the curve.

GROW

Echo Music (first priority): momentum is perishable. Fixed schedule, fan club & subscriptions push, welcome rituals, convert surge viewers into followers.

Luna Live: codify her playbook for the whole portfolio; scale hours gently (58 → ~75).

FIX

Vinyl Nights: fewer, better hours (126 → ~80); format refresh; co-host slots with rising creators.

DJ Nova: content refresh, off-peak experiments, festival-stage exposure as a new-audience injection.

SUSTAIN

BeatTheory: prevention, not rescue. Runs Luna's codified playbook, one new-format experiment per month; alert if returning % keeps rising while growth falls (early discovery-starved pattern).

OPTIONS CONSIDERED: Coaching all five equally: rejected. Echo comes first because momentum decays fastest; a surge unconverted this month is gone next month.

Festival roles are part of the fix: Echo & Luna showcase on the LIVE stage · Nova gets a stage slot as a new-audience injection · Vinyl co-hosts the semifinal events · BeatTheory mentors the bootcamp.

ADDITIONAL DATA I WOULD REQUEST

- Traffic source split: For You feed vs. followers (separates the two archetypes cleanly)
- New vs. returning viewers in absolute counts, and viewer → follower conversion
- Gifting concentration: how much revenue depends on top gifters
- Subscription penetration, time-slot performance, 90-day trend (30 days can mislead)

HOW I MEASURE SUCCESS

- **Portfolio revenue per LIVE hour:** the efficiency north star
- New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl (discovery fix working)
- Returning-viewer rate ↑ for Echo (retention fix working)
- Portfolio MoM revenue positive within 60 days (lagging validation)

One festival, three funnels: recruit the new, energize the existing, showcase the top

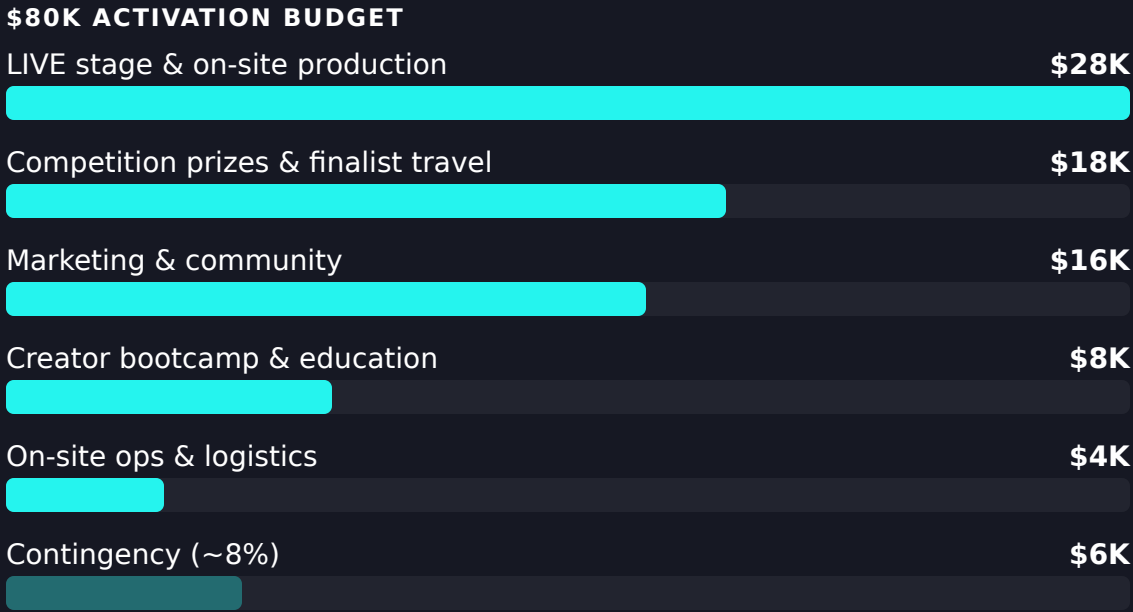
Excitement isn't a separate workstream; it's the output of the other three, clipped and amplified.

RECRUIT · "Road to Pulse" open competition: a public on-ramp for musicians who have never gone LIVE

ENERGIZE · 4-week bootcamp + archetype coaching; portfolio creators mentor and compete

SHOWCASE · TikTok LIVE stage at Pulse: finals + top-talent performances, all streamed

OPTIONS CONSIDERED: *Spreading budget evenly across five workstreams: rejected. Stage + competition compound each other; marketing amplifies a story the competition creates for free.*

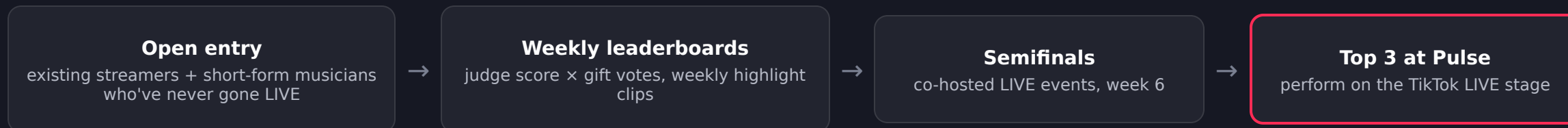


Assumption: platform traffic and product support are in-kind and outside this cash budget.

"Road to Pulse": recruit through competition, retain through education

TikTok LIVE has proven this format before (On Deck: Breakaway); I would adapt its mechanics to Pulse.

THE COMPETITION FUNNEL (WEEKS 2-8)



OPTIONS CONSIDERED: *Pure gift-voting: rejected. It's platform-native but invites volume gaming and whale capture; the judge-score gate keeps quality in the ranking. Wherever an incentive points, distortion appears right next to it.*

4-WEEK LIVE BOOTCAMP (EDUCATION)

- Streaming craft: setup, scheduling, interaction rituals
- The monetization ladder: 1K followers → Gifts → Subscriptions → 10K → Creator Rewards: a built-in growth path to coach against
- Portfolio creators run mentor sessions: their exposure fix and the entrants' education are the same event

THE PIPELINE AFTER THE FESTIVAL

- Every entrant enters a 30-day post-festival incubation track
- Graduation target: first LIVE within 2 weeks, 3 streams/week by day 30
- **The festival is a pipeline, not a finish line:** recruitment is judged at day 30, not on festival day

Assembled from proven TikTok LIVE mechanics, not invented: the prize ladder of merch, Diamonds, avatar frames, VIP tickets and a real stage slot mirrors **On Deck: Breakaway** (career capital over cash, which is why \$18K covers it) · distribution-support prizes mirror **Music On Stage** · semifinal co-hosting uses the **In Sync** matching mechanic · finalists' tracks become limited-run Gifts, as in **Songs of LIVE**.

On site, the festival is both a stage and a content factory

Three days of festival → eight weeks of content and three partner relationships that outlive the event.

ON-SITE ACTIVATIONS

- **TikTok LIVE stage:** competition finals + portfolio top-talent showcases, all streamed to the platform
- **Backstage co-streams** with festival artists (cleared in advance with labels)
- **Discovery booth:** attendees start their first LIVE on-site with staff guidance; recruitment made physical

MARKETING & COMMUNITY

- Co-branded hashtag challenge with Pulse, seeded by competition entrants
- Weekly competition highlights clipped to short-form; short-form reach feeds LIVE viewership
- Entrant community spaces: peer support now, retention channel after the festival

EXTERNAL PARTNER MANAGEMENT

- **Festival org:** deliverables SLA + weekly sync; stage specs locked by week 6
- **Agencies / Creator Networks:** recruitment channels with entry targets per partner
- **Labels & artists:** co-stream clearances start week 1: licensing lead time is the long pole

PROJECT PLAN

Eight weeks, five milestones, one weekly heartbeat



- ◆ W1 kickoff, metrics locked, licensing started
- ◆ W2 competition live
- ◆ W4 entries go/no-go checkpoint
- ◆ W6 logistics & finalists locked
- ◆ W8 festival
- ◆ W+4 retention report

BIGGEST RISKS → MITIGATIONS

Low competition entries	Agency pre-commitments; W4 checkpoint triggers paid boost from contingency
On-site tech failure	Redundant streaming setup + full rehearsal in W7
Gift-vote gaming	Judge-score gate + anomaly monitoring on voting patterns
Partner deliverables slip	SLA with weekly sync; stage specs frozen at W6
Budget overrun	8% contingency + weekly burn review

STAKEHOLDERS

Internal: Product, Data Science, Marketing, Legal & Music Licensing, Event Ops

External: Pulse festival org, agencies / Creator Networks, labels & artists

KEEPING IT ON TRACK

Weekly standup · one owner per workstream · live dashboard on entries, coaching metrics, and budget burn

SUCCESS METRICS

Measure supply first: revenue follows

Targets below are illustrative; week 1 locks them against baseline data.

LAYER	METRIC	ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET
Leading · supply	Competition entries · first-time LIVE creators · portfolio quality-weighted hours · bootcamp completion	500+ entries; 150+ first LIVEs; completion ≥ 60%
Process · engagement	Music-vertical watch time during campaign · portfolio new-viewer share · average concurrent viewers	New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl; ACV ↑ portfolio-wide
Lagging · revenue & health	Portfolio revenue MoM · revenue per LIVE hour · D30 retention of newly recruited creators	MoM positive by W8; rev/hr ↑; D30 retention ≥ 40%

Supply and retention are the cause; revenue is the effect. I act on leading metrics and am judged by lagging ones.

WHAT LEADERSHIP SEES AT DAY 30

Diagnosis done, archetype coaching live

Competition running, entries vs. target at W4 gate

Festival logistics on track, licensing under way

Metrics dashboard live, leading indicators trending